

GOOSE BUMPS



Film portraits of
touch, voice and
boundaries.

Working concept · version 5.1 · July 2026

18+ · WORK IN PROGRESS





02 · THE PROJECT

A body is not material. It is a person who decides how they are seen.

Goosebumps brings together a person's independent voice and extreme close-ups of skin, breath, fabric and touch. A face and a name are not required.

Each short film belongs to one person, or to people who choose to enter the image together. A portrait will usually run for about 3 to 6 minutes; 10 minutes is an upper limit, not a mandatory format.

The camera moves so close that the body often stops reading as obvious anatomy. What remains is pores, hair, pressure, breath, fabric, light and a small change in tension. The image is not a parade of bodies, but a map of what trust does to the body.

- 01 When do I recognise myself as an acting subject?
- 02 When do I become material for somebody else's meaning?
- 03 Who decides the edit, context and reach?

When does a body remain a present, acting subject - and when does it become an object for someone else's gaze?

Bodies are everywhere. The ability to live in them is not equally distributed.

Advertising presents the body as an endless project, platforms sort attraction into matches and reach, and intimacy can easily become measurable performance.

Goosebumps does not pretend that we can return to an innocent world before the internet. It looks for a small space in which a person is not a profile, commodity or extractable resource, but a co-author of the meaning of their own body.

The courage to be vulnerable is not a duty to reveal everything. It is the right to decide what I show, to whom, when, in what language and with what reach. Freedom here does not mean the absence of rules, but rules that are clear, shared and consciously changeable.

BODY

is not an endless project

ATTENTION

is not closeness

INTIMACY

is not performance

VISIBILITY

is not agency

Taking back everything that makes us human.

Work that makes sense. Time that need not be productive. Attention outside the algorithm. A body that is neither a brand, proof of worth, nor raw material for somebody else's gaze.

Goosebumps does not redeem vulnerability through a beautiful image. It tries to create a small space in which a person decides what to show, to whom, when, and with what reach.

WORK

that carries meaning, not only performance

TIME

that need not prove productivity

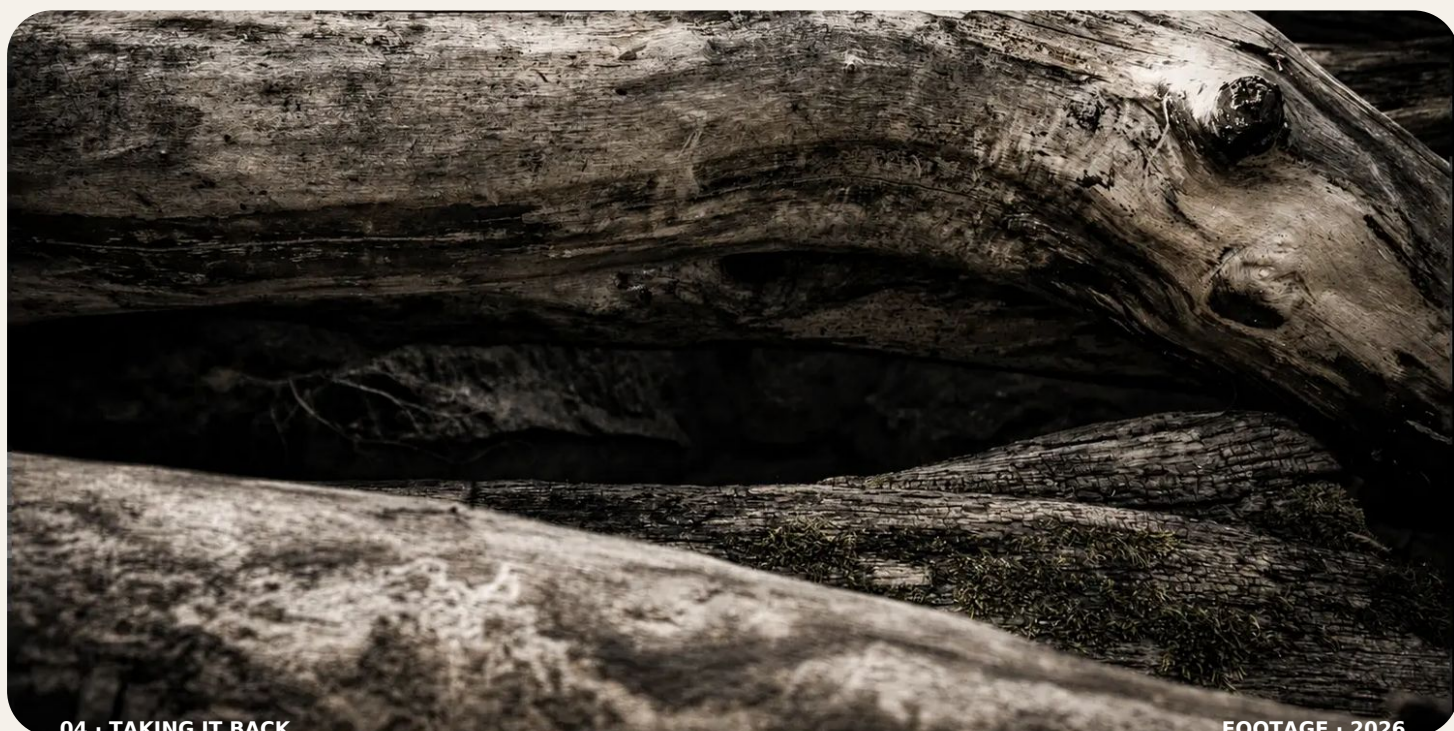
BODY

that is neither a profile nor ad space

CLOSENESS

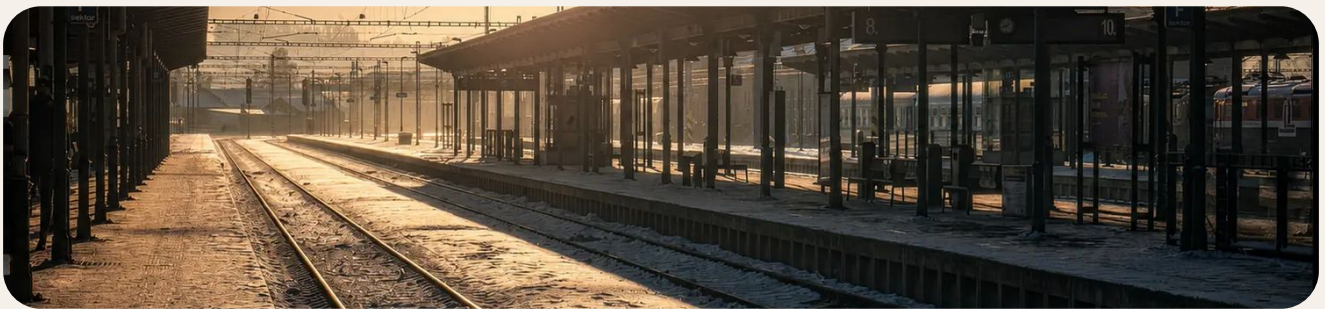
that is neither reward nor exchange

Visibility is not the same as agency. Attention is not the same as closeness.



The person comes first. The image comes second.

The first meeting takes place without a camera, without undressing and without obligation. Its purpose is not persuasion, but to find out whether working together makes sense.



01

MEETING

Expectations, concerns, accessibility, motivation and the reason to enter the portrait - or not to.

02

PROPOSAL

Image, voice, place, kind of touch, anonymity, people present and the exact scope of release.

03

FILMING

A closed space, ongoing check-ins, the right to stop and no silent change of plan.

04

EDIT

The participant sees the working and final cut and decides on each specific use.

From everyday clothing to nudity. This is not a ladder.

01

FULLY DRESSED

An embrace, hair, breath, lying together or touch through fabric.

02

PARTIAL EXPOSURE

Swimwear or a specifically agreed part of the body without full nudity.

03

NUDITY

An equal option only for a person who genuinely wants it.

04

UNCERTAINTY

It is fine not to know yet, to reduce the scope or to refuse the portrait.

Every adult body carries time, experience and its own boundaries.

The series is open to adults regardless of gender, age, body, orientation or relationship structure.

Someone may come alone, with a partner, friend, close person or group. Closeness may be romantic, friendly, caring, communal, polyamorous, playful or difficult to name. Nobody is a prop in someone else's portrait.

The project is not looking for ideal advertising bodies. It is interested in scars, hair, wrinkles, fatigue, awkwardness, pleasure, humour and ordinary presence. Participation is not an acting role or a substitute for paid work.

Accessibility is discussed concretely: a quiet or accessible venue, questions in advance, more time, a trusted companion, an online first conversation or another needed adjustment.

- 01 When do I recognise myself as an acting subject?
- 02 When do I become material for somebody else's meaning?
- 03 Who decides the edit, context and reach?

**No, uncertainty and silence are valid answers.
Refusal is not a problem to be solved.**

Three equal layers of one portrait.

The interview does not have to explain the gesture on screen. A third meaning emerges between an independent voice and a bodily image.

Anonymity is an expressive tool, not a magical promise. A face and name can be omitted, the voice can be altered and identifying details can be kept out of frame. Zero risk of recognition cannot be guaranteed: someone may recognise a tattoo, a room, a voice or a story. Specific risks are therefore discussed in advance.



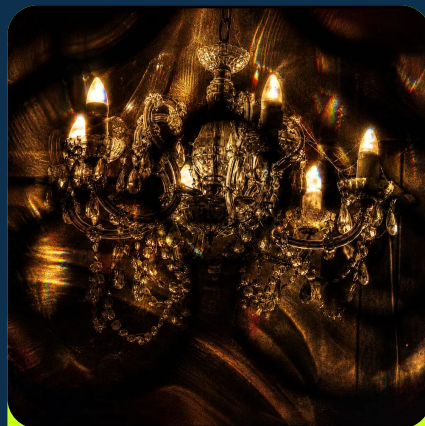
IMAGE

Close detail of skin, movement, light, shadow and material. The style grows from the particular person and place.



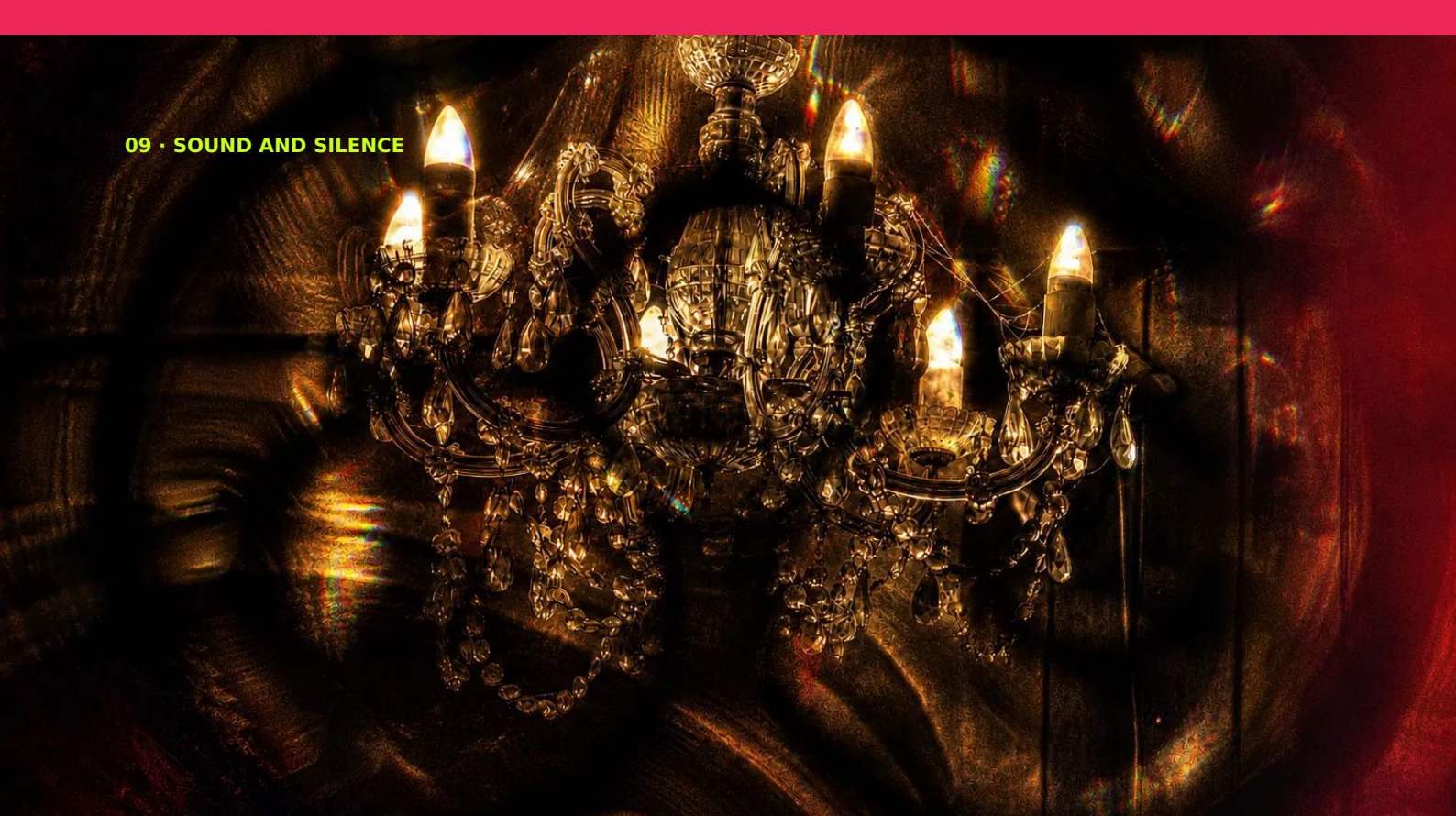
VOICE

A separate interview at a calm pace. Questions can be shared in advance; the voice may remain original, be altered or be replaced by subtitles.



SOUND

A hand on skin, breath, swallowing, rubbing fabric, a bare foot and the room's silence. Music is an option, not an instruction to feel.



Sound does not instruct the viewer what to feel.

Breath, swallowing, fabric, a hand on skin, a bare foot and the silence of a place are equal layers of a portrait. Music is optional, and the website contains no audio player.

Intolerance and Na trávě mezi stromy are working experiments and material for unfinished projects. Hajluje celá rodina is a satire on the rise of the far right, not a celebration or the Goosebumps soundtrack.

Consent is not a signature. It is a way of working.

One yes does not automatically apply to another touch, a different shot, a new edit or another release.

- The series works exclusively with adults aged 18+.
- Filming is sober and takes place in a closed space shaped around participants' needs.
- The image, touch, possible nudity, sound, anonymity and intended use are named clearly and without euphemisms.
- Anyone may bring a trusted person and agree on a stop word or gesture.
- A new idea is spoken aloud first. Work continues only after everyone understands and freely agrees.
- Before release, a shot may be removed, anonymity changed or the entire version stopped.
- A new use of sensitive material requires a new conversation and new approval.
- Recorded material stays offline on encrypted storage with restricted access.

Once a work is public, the internet cannot reliably return every copy. Reach and risk are therefore discussed over the finished cut - before release, not after it.



First, a precise short film. A larger plan may follow.

The first phase will produce several individual portraits. The first films are also being made for applications to documentary, film and multimedia schools.

Only specifically approved shots and versions may enter the portfolio, website, screening, gallery, exhibition, social platform or festival. Consent to one film is not automatic consent to every future montage.

The project is made on a small scale, with available equipment, borrowed locations and a small team. A low budget is no excuse for unclear rules. The more sensitive the situation, the more exact the preparation must be - and the scope will be reduced when capacity is insufficient.

Participation is unpaid in the first phase. If the project obtains funding, work should be paid. Voluntary support first covers documented project costs; any surplus will not become the author's personal profit and will be donated to relevant organisations and charitable activities.

COSTS → TRANSPARENCY → ANY SURPLUS TO CHARITABLE ACTIVITIES



Štěpán Chalupa

Filmmaker, director, photographer and video essayist. He holds a master's degree in Film Studies from Masaryk University.

He directed the educational format What The Fact? for Czech Television, worked at Divadlo FESTE and creates video essays, satirical formats, photography and documentary travel diaries under the name Fellean.

He is neurodivergent and sensory-sensitive. Goosebumps is therefore not made from a safe distance: the author enters the image with his own body and asks whether vulnerability can be shown without losing one's boundaries.

VÝBĚR PRÁCE

What The Fact? · Česká televize

Videoeseje · fotografie · cestovní deníky

The courage to be vulnerable

For three years I barely left my flat. Sensory defence, anxiety and my idea of a normal human being built a fortress that protected me and isolated me at the same time.

For me, 2026 is not a triumphant reboot. It is an attempt to re-enter the world — through a northern journey, moving home, friendship, cold water and days that were simply fucking awful.

Vulnerability here does not mean revealing everything. It means no longer performing a perfectly prepared role while retaining the right to say no.



A clenched fist can survive a blow, but it cannot embrace.



Sensitivity / defence

Protection that can turn into a cage.



Matter / contact

Body and material without a preset hierarchy.



Face / silencing

A presence whose voice passes through foreign filters.



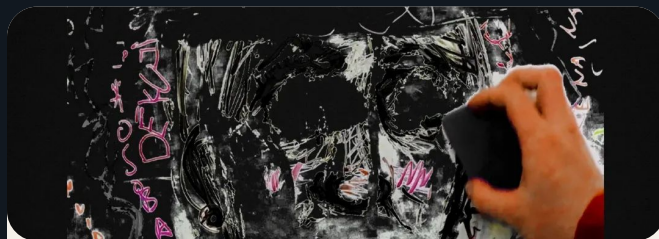
Gaze / distortion

Uncertainty about surface and space.



Carolee Schneemann · Fuses · 1964-1967

Her own lovemaking is disrupted by dyeing, scratching, burning and layering the filmstrip. The body becomes film material, duration and texture rather than a smooth object.



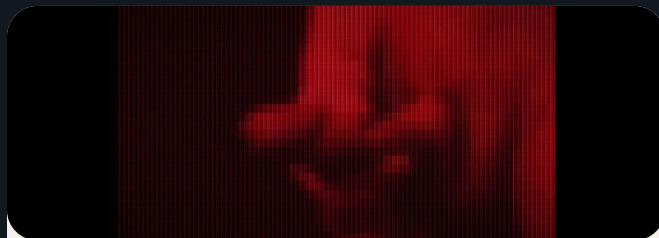
Barbara Hammer · Dyketactics · 1974

A four-minute montage of bodies, nature and queer closeness. Editing composes touch through colour, movement and surface instead of turning bodies into performance.



Pipilotti Rist · Pickelporno · 1992

Extreme bodily details merge with nature and psychedelic colour. The camera moves between touching people without translating their closeness into a conventional pornographic gaze.



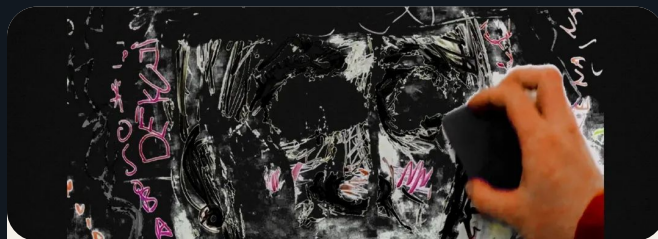
Barbara Hammer · Sync Touch · 1981

The film places touch and vision at the centre of its form. It is a precise reference for the aim of Goosebumps: not merely showing touch, but letting the image think haptically.



Clio Barnard · The Arbor · 2010

Actors lip-sync authentic interviews. Vocabulary, rhythm and breath remain while the visible face belongs to someone else: a model of anonymity that does not erase personality.



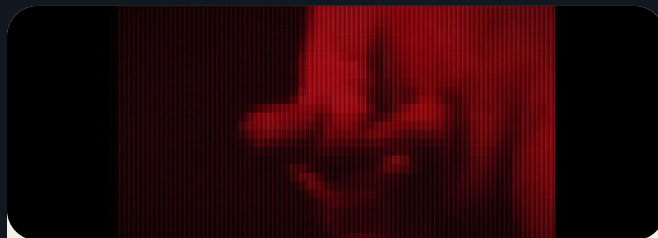
Clayton Cubitt · Hysterical Literature · 2012

A face, voice and concentration carry a bodily response to off-screen stimulation. Its formal economy is useful; its experimental frame also warns how easily a person can become a result.



John Cameron Mitchell · Shortbus · 2006

Explicit sexuality remains part of characters' lives, humour and relationships. Explicitness does not flatten a person by itself; flattening begins when their world disappears.



Marina Abramović · Rhythm 0 · 1974

For six hours the artist offered her body and 72 objects to an audience. For this project it works mainly as a contrast: a participant must never cease to be an acting co-author.

The project is grounded in research, critical image-making and practical rules.

These sources are not a safety certificate. They help formulate the questions and translate ethics into a concrete working framework.

- 01** Laura U. Marks: *The Skin of the Film*. Duke University Press, 2000.
- 02** Eva Illouz: *Cold Intimacies*. Polity Press, 2007.
- 03** Audre Lorde: *Uses of the Erotic: The Erotic as Power*, 1978.
- 04** Marcel Mauss: *Les techniques du corps*, 1934.
- 05** Taina Bucher: *If...Then: Algorithmic Power and Politics*. Oxford University Press, 2018.
- 06** SAG-AFTRA: *Standards and Protocols for the Use of Intimacy Coordinators*.
- 07** Bectu / Equity: *Guidance for Shooting Intimacy*, 2022.
- 08** von Mohr et al.: *Social touch deprivation during COVID-19*. Royal Society Open Science, 2021.

The full bibliography, original essays and direct links are available on the project website.



GOOSE
BUMPS



The first meeting is without a camera, undressing, obligation or persuasion.

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WHAT CHANGED AFTER EARLY FEEDBACK

- The first message names one role: participation, consultation or collaboration.
- A fully dressed portrait is equal. Nudity is never the “advanced” version.
- A refusal ends recruitment; there is no persuasive follow-up.
- Consent approves a specific cut and use, not a blanket permission in advance.

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